Conversation — track 8, 10, 11

Heidi heard that Frank criticized her project at yesterday's meeting. She wants to talk to him about it.

Heidi: Frank, got a minute? I heard you called my project a disaster.

Frank: Hang on. **What I said was** that the deadline was a disaster.

Heidi: Really? Because that's not how it came across.

Frank: Honestly, **it's the client who** keeps changing the brief, not you.

Heidi: Then why did Jake say you were annoyed with me?

Frank: Jake got the wrong end of the stick. **What annoyed me was** all the last-minute changes.

Heidi: OK. But **what really hurt was** hearing it from someone else.

Frank: That's fair. Sorry. Next time, I'll come straight to you.

Study Notes

Jake got the wrong end of the stick.
Jake hiểu nhầm rồi.
Thành ngữ hay dùng ở Anh: hiểu sai hoàn toàn ý của người khác.
Cách nói tương đương: Jake misunderstood.

Next time, I'll come straight to you.
Lần sau có gì tôi sẽ nói trực tiếp với bạn.
"come straight to someone" là tìm gặp và nói thẳng với chính người đó, không để họ nghe lại qua người khác.
Cách nói tương đương: Next time, I'll talk to you directly.

Speak Like a Native — track 9

1. What I said was that the deadline was a disaster.
linking: "What‿I"
weak: "was", "that"
strong: "said", "deadline"
Nhấn mạnh "deadline" để sửa lại ý (hạn chót, chứ không phải dự án). "What I" nối thành "wo-tai": giọng Anh giữ /t/, giọng Mỹ đọc "wa-đai".

2. Honestly, it's the client who keeps changing the brief, not you.
weak: "who"
strong: "client", "you"
Câu chẻ "it's… who…" đặt từ cần nhấn (client) vào giữa câu; nhấn "client" và "you" để đối lập. Ngắt nhẹ trước "not you". Chữ "h" trong "Honestly" câm.

3. But what really hurt was hearing it from someone else.
linking: "hearing‿it", "someone‿else"
strong: "hurt", "else"
Lên giọng nhẹ ở "hurt" và ngừng ngắn, rồi mới nói ý chính. "hearing it" nối thành "hia-ring-it"; "someone else" thành "sơm-wơ-nels".

• Câu chẻ chia hai phần: phần "What I said was…" lên giọng nhẹ và ngừng ngắn, rồi nhấn ý chính ở phần sau.
• Khi sửa hiểu lầm, nhấn mạnh từ mang ý đối lập: the DEADLINE (không phải the project), the CLIENT (không phải you).
• Giọng Anh (Frank) giữ /t/ rõ: What I → "wo-tai"; giọng Mỹ (Heidi) đọc "wa-đai".

Grammar Focus

Câu chẻ với What: What + mệnh đề + is/was…

Đưa phần quan trọng ra sau "is/was" để nhấn mạnh hoặc sửa lại ý. Hay gặp: What I meant was…, What I need is…, What surprised me was…

What I meant was that I need more time.
What I need is a good night's sleep.
What surprised me was how cheap it was.

Câu chẻ với It: It is/was + X + who/that…

Nhấn mạnh người hoặc vật X đã làm việc gì, thường để sửa một thông tin sai. Dùng who cho người, that cho vật.

It was Mai who booked the hotel, not me.
It's the noise that bothers me, not the heat.
Was it you who called me last night?

Role Play — track 13

A: Frank, got a minute? I heard you called my project a disaster.

B: Hang on. What I said was that _____.

A: Really? Because that's not how it came across.

B: Honestly, it's the client who _____, not you.

A: Then why did Jake say you were annoyed with me?

B: Jake got the wrong end of the stick. What annoyed me was _____.

A: OK. But what really hurt was hearing it from someone else.

B: That's fair. Sorry. Next time, I'll come straight to you.

Substitution Drill — track 14

1. What I said was that **the deadline was a disaster**.
   a. the timing was awful
   b. we needed more help
   c. the budget was too tight

2. Honestly, it's the client who **keeps changing the brief**, not you.
   a. keeps moving the goalposts
   b. can't make up their mind
   c. wants everything yesterday

3. What annoyed me was **all the last-minute changes**.
   a. the lack of support
   b. the endless emails
   c. the way it was planned